

INTO UNCHARTED TERRITORY

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The Esports World Cup (EWC) might have been another of Saudi Arabia's opportunities to showcase its prowess in organising global sporting events. For India, however, it was a chance to leave a mark in uncharted territory.

Two Indian chess grandmasters, Arjun Erigaisi and Nihal Sarin, competed in the online chess finals — both reached the quarterfinals, with Erigaisi finishing fourth.

Sarin, representing Indian esports organisation S8UL Esports, defeated Anish Giri and Maxime Vachier-Lagrave before falling to eventual champion Magnus Carlsen in the quarterfinals.

"I have never experienced anything like the love of S8UL Esports before. Esports World Cup is a dream! It was an honour to play Magnus in a match, which is different from facing him in a tournament game. Got crushed yesterday. Lots to learn," Sarin wrote on X.

S8UL—the first and only Indian esports organisation at the EWC—had more reasons to celebrate. Its athlete

: Jonny reached the quarterfinals in EA Sports FC 25, while
: their Apex Legends team advanced to the Grand Finals.

UPSETS AND UNDERDOG TRIUMPHS

: The tournament was not short of surprises. In
: Rainbow Six Siege X, favourites Team Falcons suffered an
: early exit, while the world No. 1 in FC Pro 25, Anders
: "Vejrgang"
: Vejrgang, failed to
: make the top 16.

: Against all odds,
: Team Liquid's
: Manuel
: "ManuBachooore"
: Bachooore clinched
: the title, defeating
: Team Vitality's
: Brice "Brice"
: Masson 5-3. The
: Dutchman became



VALORANT RANKINGS



ABHIRUP
"LIGHTNINGFAST" CHOUDHURY



GANESH
"SKROSSI" GANGADHAR



SHRAVANA
"TECHNO" SAHOO



AMAN
"HOAX" YADAV



SAGNIK
"HELLFF" ROY